

JETRO Business Brief 2026/07/21

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【ASIA-OCEANIA】

Japanese companies strengthen B-to-C expansion through e-commerce at healthcare-related exhibition in Shandong Province (China)

●Qingdao

Chinese major beverage chain "Nayuki Hippo Tea" to build beer factory in Chengdu's Qingbaijiang District (China)

●Chengdu

Bank of Korea raises benchmark interest rate to 2.75%, shifting to tightening for first time in three and a half years (South Korea)

●Seoul

South Korean government announces "Second Half 2026 Economic Growth Strategy," revises upward 2026 growth outlook (South Korea)

●Seoul

South Korea's June exports exceed \$100 billion, with semiconductor exports continuing to perform strongly (South Korea)

●Investigation Department, China & North Asia Division

Megmilk Snow Brand Vietnam begins factory operations in Tay Ninh Province in the south (Vietnam, Japan)

●Ho Chi Minh City

Cambodia-Japan Chamber of Commerce inspects Funan Techo Canal construction site, 2028 completion target remains unchanged (Cambodia, ASEAN, Japan)

●Phnom Penh

Australia deepens cooperation with India across defense, energy, cybersecurity and other sectors, to expand uranium exports (Australia, India)

●Sydney

Australia establishes "Office of AI" as command center for AI administration, to develop national standards for AI regulation (Australia)

●Sydney

【NORTH AMERICA & CENTRAL/SOUTH AMERICA】

Trump administration announces 50% additional tariffs on Canadian dairy products, alcohol, and auto parts, first measure under Section 338 (US, Canada, Mexico)

● New York

US USTR announces implementation of 25% Section 301 tariffs on Brazil (US, Brazil)

● New York

North America's largest East Coast food trade show held in New York City, Japan Pavilion features 33 companies and organizations (US, Japan)

● New York

US retail sales in June increased 0.2% from previous month, led by online retail and automobiles (US)

● New York

Archer and Beta plan to build charging infrastructure network for electric aircraft at up to 250 locations nationwide (US)

● San Francisco

US National Science Foundation announces second phase grant regions for cutting-edge research assistance program (US)

● Chicago

Trump administration announces relief measures for Section 232 aluminum tariffs, targeting companies investing in the US (US)

● Investigation Department, Americas Division

Prime Minister Carney opposes US additional tariff policy, expresses intention to strengthen CUSMA negotiations (Canada, US, Mexico)

● Investigation Department, Americas Division

Peru's incoming Second Vice President emphasizes Japan's cooperation is essential for development (Peru)

● Lima

【EUROPE, RUSSIA, CENTRAL ASIA & CAUCASUS】

European Commission releases operational report on foreign subsidy rules, to streamline some procedures (EU, China)

● Brussels

European Commission reviews import monitoring system with focus on addressing overproduction (EU, China)

● Brussels

Kansai startup participates in Vivatech, Europe's largest open innovation exhibition (France, Japan)

● Osaka Headquarters, Innovation Division

【MIDDLE EAST & AFRICA】

UAE government condemns attacks by Iran on Middle Eastern countries (UAE, Iran, US, Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar, Jordan)

- Dubai

Turkey enforces "Novel Food" regulation aimed at ensuring food safety and promoting innovation (Turkey, EU)

- Istanbul

【JAPAN】

JETRO holds Japan-Germany Open Innovation Forum in Hamamatsu (Japan, Germany)

- Hamamatsu